



Author's Point of View and Purpose

Grade 7 • North Carolina • Reading

RI.7.6

Determine each author's point of view and purpose in two passages on school uniforms, and analyze how each author distinguishes their position from the opposing view. An 80-minute block-period packet with warm-up, guided practice, partner discussion, independent practice, small-group work, and a full answer key.

PRINT • TEACH • REVISIT



Plan the 80-minute block

Level and alignment

Grade 7 · North Carolina · Reading; RI.7.6 — Determine an author's point of view or purpose in a text and analyze how the author distinguishes his or her position from that of others.

What is included

Cover; teacher guide; vocabulary and lesson preview; original passage; warm-up (2 items); guided practice with organizer (4 items); partner discussion (3 items); independent practice (6 items); small-group intervention and enrichment (4 items); exit ticket; complete answer key; access and sources page.

Suggested pacing (80 minutes)

Warm-up 8 min · passage + guided practice 25 min · partner discussion 12 min · independent practice 20 min · small-group work 10 min · exit ticket 5 min.

Preparation

Print student pages separately from the answer key. Review the passage and organizer before class. No outside novel or paid app required.

Student directions

Read the passage carefully. Use evidence from the text to support every answer. Quote or closely paraphrase the text and name the paragraph.



Before you read

Key vocabulary

Lesson focus

An author's point of view is their opinion or stance on a topic. Purpose is why they wrote the text (to persuade, inform, entertain). Authors distinguish their position by acknowledging the opposing view and then explaining why their own view is stronger.

Model 1 — An author writes: "Some argue uniforms limit expression. But uniforms save families money and reduce morning conflict." What technique is used?

Acknowledging the opposing view ("some argue...") before countering it with the author's own reasons, a common way authors distinguish their position.

Model 2 — What is the likely purpose of a text that uses phrases like "we must" and "it is essential that"?

To persuade — this language pushes readers toward a specific action or belief, rather than simply informing them.



WARM-UP

Warm-up · Before you read

Answer using what you already know. Five minutes.

1. What is the author of Passage A's point of view on school uniforms?

2. What is the author of Passage B's point of view on school uniforms?



Passage A: A Uniform Solution

1. Walk into any middle school cafeteria without a uniform policy, and you will see the problem before anyone explains it to you: clothing has become a sorting mechanism, separating students by what their families can afford.

2. Critics of uniform policies argue that uniforms suppress individual expression, and it is true that students lose some choice over daily clothing. But this argument overlooks what students gain: a measurable reduction in appearance-based social pressure. Schools that adopted uniform policies report fewer incidents of clothing-related teasing and bullying, according to several district surveys conducted after policy changes.

3. Uniforms also address a quieter, practical problem: cost. A family purchasing five uniform outfits spends significantly less over a school year than a family trying to keep a middle schooler current with rotating trends. For families already stretched thin, this is not a minor benefit.

4. Some worry uniforms erase individuality entirely. But individuality was never really about clothing brands — it shows up in how students speak, create, lead, and think. A uniform policy removes one narrow, expensive avenue for self-expression while leaving every meaningful one intact.

5. Schools exist to prepare students for a world with expectations and structures. A uniform policy, thoughtfully applied, teaches an early, low-stakes lesson in operating within a shared system — while quietly leveling a field that, without it, was never level to begin with.



Passage B: Let Students Choose

1. Proponents of uniform policies point to reduced bullying and lower costs. These benefits sound appealing, but they treat a symptom while ignoring the actual problem, and they come at a real cost to something schools should be protecting, not restricting: student voice.
2. Clothing is one of the first spaces where young people practice self-definition. A student who dresses in a way that reflects their culture, their interests, or simply their mood that day is exercising a small, daily act of agency. Removing that choice does not resolve social pressure around appearance; it just redirects it toward hairstyles, shoes, and backpacks, the details uniform policies cannot regulate.
3. The cost argument deserves scrutiny, too. Uniform policies often require families to buy specific branded items from a limited number of approved vendors, sometimes at prices comparable to, or higher than, ordinary clothing. The savings claimed by uniform advocates are not guaranteed, and in some districts, families have reported the opposite.
4. If the goal is genuinely reducing appearance-based bullying, schools have more direct tools: explicit anti-bullying policies, restorative discipline practices, and a school culture that actively values difference rather than erasing it through matching outfits.
5. Structure and expectations matter in schools, but so does teaching students to navigate a world of real choices, not a simplified one where a single daily decision has been made for them. A uniform is not a lesson in responsibility; it is the absence of an opportunity to practice it.



Guided practice · Evidence organizer

Work through this organizer together before independent practice.

It Says Quote or closely paraphrase the text.	It Means Explain the evidence in your own words.	And So State the inference or analysis it supports.

1. What is the likely purpose of both passages?

2. How does Passage A's author acknowledge the opposing view, according to paragraph 2?

3. How does Passage A distinguish its position after acknowledging that opposing view?

4. How does Passage B's author acknowledge the opposing view, according to paragraph 1?

Partner discussion

Discuss each question with a partner before writing a joint response.

1. How does Passage B distinguish its position after acknowledging that opposing view?

2. What specific evidence does Passage A use to support its cost argument?

3. How does Passage B challenge that same cost argument?



Independent practice

Work independently. Cite evidence from the text in every answer.

1. What alternative solution does Passage B propose instead of uniforms, according to paragraph 4?

2. How do both passages use the word "individuality" or "individual expression" differently to support opposite conclusions?

3. What tone does Passage A use in its final paragraph, and how does it support the author's purpose?



Independent practice

Work independently. Cite evidence from the text in every answer.

4. What tone does Passage B use in its final paragraph, and how does it support the author's purpose?

5. Both authors mention "cost." How does each author use this same topic to support opposite positions?

6. Which passage's argument about bullying do you find more directly supported by evidence within the text? Explain.



Small-group work

Use with students who need additional support.

1. How does each author's choice of what to discuss first (paragraph 1) reveal their distinct position?

2. Explain how Passage B's author distinguishes their position from Passage A's specific claim about reduced bullying.



Small-group work

Use with students ready for additional challenge.

1. If you combined the strongest point from each passage, what compromise position might emerge?

2. Why is it useful to read two opposing viewpoints on the same topic rather than just one?



Exit ticket

Answer independently to show what you learned today.

1. Identify each author's point of view, purpose, and one specific technique they use to distinguish their position from the opposing side.



Exit ticket · self-assessment

Rate today's work:

4 — I can teach this to someone else.

3 — I can do this independently.

2 — I can do this with help.

1 — I need to revisit this with my teacher.



Answer key

1. In favor of uniform policies — the author argues they reduce social pressure and cost.
2. Opposed to uniform policies — the author argues they restrict student voice and self-expression.
3. To persuade readers to support or oppose school uniform policies.
4. The author admits "students lose some choice over daily clothing" and that critics argue uniforms "suppress individual expression" before countering with the benefit of reduced social pressure.
5. It argues that individuality "shows up in how students speak, create, lead, and think," not through clothing, so removing uniform choice does not erase meaningful self-expression.

Accept equivalent, well-supported alternative answers throughout.



Answer key

6. The author admits the benefits (reduced bullying, lower costs) "sound appealing" before arguing they only treat a symptom rather than the real problem.

7. It argues that removing clothing choice does not resolve social pressure, but instead "redirects it toward hairstyles, shoes, and backpacks," and proposes more direct solutions like anti-bullying policies.

8. It states that families purchasing uniform outfits "spend significantly less over a school year" than families keeping up with rotating clothing trends.

9. Paragraph 3 argues that uniform policies often require buying specific branded items from limited vendors, sometimes at prices comparable to or higher than ordinary clothing, and that savings are "not guaranteed."

10. Explicit anti-bullying policies, restorative discipline practices, and a school culture that values difference.

Accept equivalent, well-supported alternative answers throughout.



Answer key

11. Passage A argues individuality is unaffected by uniforms since it shows up in speech and ideas, while Passage B argues clothing itself is a meaningful, daily act of self-expression that uniforms take away.

12. A confident, reasoning tone ("thoughtfully applied," "quietly leveling a field"), reinforcing the persuasive purpose by presenting uniforms as a fair, sensible solution.

13. A firm, values-driven tone ("the absence of an opportunity to practice it"), reinforcing the persuasive purpose by framing uniforms as a missed lesson in responsibility rather than a source of it.

14. Passage A uses cost as evidence in favor of uniforms (families save money); Passage B uses cost as evidence against uniforms (families may not actually save, given branded-vendor pricing).

15. Answers vary; Passage A cites "district surveys" showing fewer incidents, which is a specific evidence type, while Passage B argues bullying is "redirected" without citing a specific study — a reasonable answer could favor either, if the reasoning is supported.

Accept equivalent, well-supported alternative answers throughout.



Answer key

16. Passage A opens by describing clothing as an unfair economic "sorting mechanism," framing the issue around fairness; Passage B opens by directly challenging the opposing side's "appealing" benefits, framing the issue around scrutinizing claims.

17. Passage B does not deny that uniform policies might correlate with less reported clothing-based bullying, but argues the underlying social pressure is only "redirected" elsewhere, not resolved, distinguishing a deeper critique from Passage A's surface-level claim.

18. Answers vary; a reasonable synthesis might combine Passage A's cost/fairness goal with Passage B's call for direct anti-bullying policies, suggesting schools could pursue both affordability measures and explicit anti-bullying programs rather than relying on uniforms alone.

19. It helps readers understand the full range of evidence and reasoning on an issue, recognize how authors use the same facts (like cost) to reach different conclusions, and form a more informed opinion.

20. Answers vary; require a correctly identified point of view and purpose for at least one passage, plus one specific technique (such as acknowledging and countering the opposing view) with textual evidence.

Accept equivalent, well-supported alternative answers throughout.



Access, sources, and license

AIG

Ask for a second interpretation, a counterexample, or a student-written item at the same rigor, with an explanation of the choice.

504

Follow the individual plan: extended time, breaks, enlarged print, reduced copying, or an alternate response method as documented.

EC

Pre-teach key vocabulary before reading. Model the first guided-practice item aloud. Accept oral or dictated responses when appropriate.

ESL

Preview key vocabulary with examples. Allow brief home-language discussion before independent writing. Provide sentence starters for open-response items.

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RI.7.6 — Determine an author's point of view or purpose in a text and analyze how the author distinguishes his or her position from that of others.. The objective is original wording describing a focused part of the standard.

NC ELA Standard Course of Study, Grade 7: <https://www.dpi.nc.gov/documents/publications/catalog/>

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